



AD FACTOR

Elsie Nanji

51, Entrepreneur

Elsie Nanji is a proud mother, not only of her two children but also of her year-old design company, Red Lion. "My first job was at Lintas on a salary of Rs 700 a month," she says. But for the better part of the last three decades she remained on top of the advertising ladder as chief creative officer and partner at Ambience, an agency she nurtured since its inception. Ambience gave the world the Madhu Sapre-Milind Soman-cobra-in-the-middle Tuffs shoes ad and the Taste the Thunder jingle. "I felt that though the agency had grown, everything had become too corporate and big," she says. That is why she decided to return to what she does best, design, and started Red Lion. One hand on her wireless Apple mouse and the other changing tracks on her iPod, Nanji is happiest when delving into the creative side of her life.

FIRST INVESTMENT I bought a 450 sq ft studio apartment at Breach Candy in Mumbai, 25 years ago.

WORST INVESTMENT DECISION AND THE LESSON LEARNT I enrolled in a weight reduction programme and even paid Rs 10,000 but did not follow it for a single day. It taught me that one should never do anything half-heartedly.

PROPERTY WATCH I bought a farmhouse at Kashid, near Mumbai, 16 years ago.

BIGGEST INDULGENCE Gadgets are my weakness. From the latest Bose speakers for my iPod to an iPhone, I indulge in technology more than anything else.

MOST EXTRAVAGANT GIFT Cars. I gifted a Maruti Swift to my mother and bought an Esteem for my sister.

BIGGEST ACHIEVEMENT Having built Ambience, I am happy it is called a place that produces good work.

**USE
THIS
TIP**

"EVEN IF YOU HAVE TO STRETCH YOURSELF FINANCIALLY, INVEST IN A HOUSE. IT DOES PAY OFF IN THE LONG RUN."